6 · User information and instructions

The user information document carries the security facts a user needs to buy, commission, run and retire the product safely. Art 13(18) and Annex II require the listed information to accompany every product "at minimum" (Annex II), "in paper or electronic form" (Art 13(18)). Write one versioned document per product or family, publish it at a stable URL, and file a copy in the technical documentation (Annex VII pt 1).

At a glance

Item	Detail
Legal basis	Art 13(18); Annex II pts 1-9; Art 13(16) (manufacturer contact), 13(17) (single point of contact), 13(19) (end date at purchase), 13(11) (archive warnings)
Needed for	Every product with digital elements, whatever its class. No Commission or ENISA template exists
Owner	Technical writing lead, with the product security officer
Approver	Compliance lead
When to create	Before placing on the market; freeze the text per version at the release gate
When to update	Each new version or substantial modification; any change of contact, support end date, update method or decommissioning steps. Publish a new version page and keep the old one
Retention	Available for 10 years or the support period, whichever is longer; information provided online stays online (Art 13(18))
Feeds	Template 4, Annex VII pt 1; Template 5, Annex II pt 6 carries the declaration address; Template 7, pt 2 carries the CVD contact; Template 3, pt 7 carries the end date; Template 8, user-notice channels

How to complete

1. Pull intended purpose, foreseeable misuse and residual risks from the product definition record and Template 2.
2. Take the support end month and year per version from Template 3, and the contact and policy URL from Template 7.
3. Fill one row per Annex II point below. Write concrete steps, not disclaimers.
4. Publish at a versioned URL such as `/security/<product>/<version>/` with a `latest` alias. Never delete a version page while its retention runs.
5. Place each item where the table says: manual, website, packaging, product label or app.
6. Check the text against the shipped behaviour, especially the automatic-update opt-out (pt 8(e)).
7. Use language easily understood by users and by market surveillance authorities in the Member States of sale.

Template

Annex II point	What to write	Where it appears	Example: L2 Smart Lock (illustrative)
1. Manufacturer	Manufacturer name; postal address; email or other digital contact; website where available. Art 13(16) also requires identity and contact on the product, packaging or accompanying document	Product label or packaging; manual; website	Example Group [legal entity], Home & Building Solutions, [street], [postcode] [city], Germany; support@example.com; www.example.com
2. Vulnerability contact	Single point of contact for vulnerability reports and where the CVD policy is found. Same contact as security.txt. Not limited to automated tools (Art 13(17))	Manual; website; app (Settings > About)	psirt@example.com; web form www.example.com/security/report; phone [+49 number], staffed [hours]. Policy: www.example.com/security/cvd-policy

Annex II point	What to write	Where it appears	Example: L2 Smart Lock (illustrative)
3. Product identification	Name, type and information enabling unique identification	Product label; packaging; manual; app	L2 Smart Lock, type L2, SKUs L2-STD, L2-KEY, L2-RTF; serial on rear plate; firmware version in app (Settings > About)
4. Intended purpose and security	Intended purpose; the security environment the manufacturer assumes; essential functionalities; security properties	Manual; website	Residential front-door lock for consumers. Assumes a home Wi-Fi network, a supported smartphone and the Example Group access-management cloud. Functions: lock, unlock, app keys, guest access, access log. Properties: per-device credentials, signed firmware, encrypted app and cloud traffic
5. Use and misuse risks	Known or foreseeable circumstances of use or misuse that may lead to significant cybersecurity risks, each with the compensating measure	Manual; website	Guest keys shared without an expiry date: set an end date for every guest key. Phone with an outdated operating system: keep the phone updated. Automatic updates turned off: unpatched locks can be opened by known attacks
6. Declaration address	Internet address of the EU declaration of conformity, where applicable	Manual; packaging (with Annex VI text); website	www.example.com/security/l2/declaration/
7. Support type and end date	Type of technical security support and the end date of the support period. Art 13(19) requires at least the month and year at the time of purchase	Packaging; point of sale and web shop; manual; website; app	Free security updates installed automatically over the air until [month year] (10-year support period from first placing)
8(a). Secure use	Measures at initial commissioning and throughout the lifetime	Quick-start guide; manual; app onboarding	Install the latest firmware during set-up; set the owner account with two-step sign-in; review the access log monthly; revoke unused keys
8(b). Changes and data security	How changes to the product can affect the security of data	Manual; website	Linking a third-party smart home bridge or adding users widens who can unlock. A factory reset removes all keys and pairings

Annex II point	What to write	Where it appears	Example: L2 Smart Lock (illustrative)
8(c). Installing updates	How security-relevant updates can be installed	Manual; app; website	Updates install automatically overnight. Manual check: app > Settings > Firmware > Check now
8(d). Decommissioning	Secure decommissioning, including secure removal of user data	Manual; website; app	Remove the lock from your account in the app, then hold the reset button for [10] seconds. This erases keys, logs and the cloud binding
8(e). Turning off automatic updates	How to turn off default automatic installation of security updates (Annex I Part I pt 2(c)), with the risk of doing so	Manual; app; website	App > Settings > Updates > Automatic security updates: Off. Postpone allows up to [n] days. Without updates the lock stays exposed to fixed vulnerabilities
8(f). Integration	For products intended for integration: what integrators need to meet Annex I and Annex VII	Integrator guide; website	Not applicable: L2 is a finished product. If [the integration API] is offered to integrators, document it here
9. SBOM access	Where users can access the SBOM. Optional: include only if the manufacturer chooses to offer it	Website, if offered	Not offered to users. The SBOM is held in the technical file for market surveillance requests (Annex VII pt 8)

Publication checklist

Item	Rule	Basis
Form	Paper or electronic; a versioned documentation URL satisfies it	Art 13(18)
Availability	10 years or the support period, whichever is longer; online copies kept online	Art 13(18)
End date at purchase	At least the month and year, on the product, packaging or digitally at the time of purchase; end-of-support notice in the product where feasible	Art 13(19)

Item	Rule	Basis
Archive warnings	Public archives of old versions only with clear risk warnings	Art 13(11)
One page	The versioned security page can host the CE marking for software, the declaration, the advisory index and archive warnings	Art 30(1); Annex VI; Annex II

Common mistakes

- Point 5 written as a disclaimer. Write concrete conditions and compensating measures, carried over from residual risks in the risk assessment.
- A point 2 contact that differs from security.txt, or a chatbot as the only channel (Art 13(17)).
- No end month and year at the point of sale, or no per-version support declaration for software (Art 13(19)).
- Point 8(e) text that does not match the real opt-out, postponement and notification behaviour.
- A logging opt-out that silently disables security events without saying so in the user information.

Template 6 · v1.0 · 31 Oct 2026 · Not legal advice; confirm wording against the Official Journal text before use.